

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 131

By Sparks

A RESOLUTION to raise awareness of the importance of positive male role models and mentorship opportunities in schools, nonprofit organizations, and faith-based organizations.

WHEREAS, many children in our country do not have positive father figures or male role models involved in their education, as, according to the 2010 U.S. Census, 17.25 million children are being raised in a single-mother family; and

WHEREAS, children who have fathers or positive male role models involved in their lives are more likely to get better grades, have better verbal and problem-solving skills, and do better on achievement tests; and

WHEREAS, the U.S. Department of Education reported in 2012 that such children also demonstrate a higher tolerance for stress and frustration and are more likely to have positive peer relationships, to participate in extracurricular activities, and to have fewer discipline problems; and

WHEREAS, studies have also shown that the involvement of a father or positive male role model in the lives of children promotes a child's physical well-being, greater ability to take initiative, and evidence of self-control; and

WHEREAS, mentoring programs in schools have proven to be a cost-efficient way of increasing the positive relationships students have in their lives, while also having the potential to boost factors that can lead to educational success; and

WHEREAS, community-based mentoring programs operated by nonprofit organizations or faith-based organizations can help ensure that today's students have positive male role models in their lives, helping to give them the tools and support they need to succeed by

improving social skills, bolstering self-esteem, and providing career exploration while also supporting academic activities; and

WHEREAS, by working together, local organizations can establish mentorship opportunities that specifically meet the needs of those children who do not have positive male role models in their lives; and

WHEREAS, the expansion of such mentorship programs in the State of Tennessee by schools, nonprofit organizations, and faith-based organizations would be a benefit to countless students in the areas of educational attainment, future employment potential, and social well-being; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we hereby acknowledge the importance of positive male role models in the lives of Tennessee's children and urge schools, nonprofit organizations, and faith-based organizations to place more positive male role models in our schools and classrooms through mentorship opportunities.